

The Solo Sanctuary

A Guide to Home Safety & Security

PEACE OF MIND CHECKLIST

Reinforcing Your Doors

Securing Windows & Sliders

Smart Security Upgrades

The 9 PM Safety Routine

Emergency Readiness

Introduction

Security isn't about living in fear; it's about being prepared. Living alone is an incredible milestone, and with a few simple DIY upgrades, you can ensure your home remains a sanctuary of peace and independence.

PRO HACK

Reinforcing the Front Door

The weakest point of your door is the frame. Most door hinges are held on by tiny 1-inch screws.

The 3-Inch Rule: Replace the middle screw in each hinge with a **3-inch wood screw**. This anchors the door directly into the house's framing, making it nearly impossible to kick in.

Smart Security (Low Cost)

Use smart plugs to put your lights on timers. Use the "Away Mode" to simulate presence while you are out for dinner or traveling. Consider a digital peephole camera for the front door to see visitors from your phone.

The 9 PM Routine

Habits are more powerful than any alarm system. Every night at 9 PM, perform a quick sweep:

- Check that all doors and windows are locked.
- Ensure the porch light is on.
- Charge your phone on your nightstand.
- Set your car keys in a consistent, accessible spot.

Emergency Readiness

Designate your bedroom as your "Safe Room." Keep a heavy flashlight on your nightstand—it's both a tool and a deterrent. Ensure your ICE (In Case of Emergency) contacts are updated on your phone lock screen.